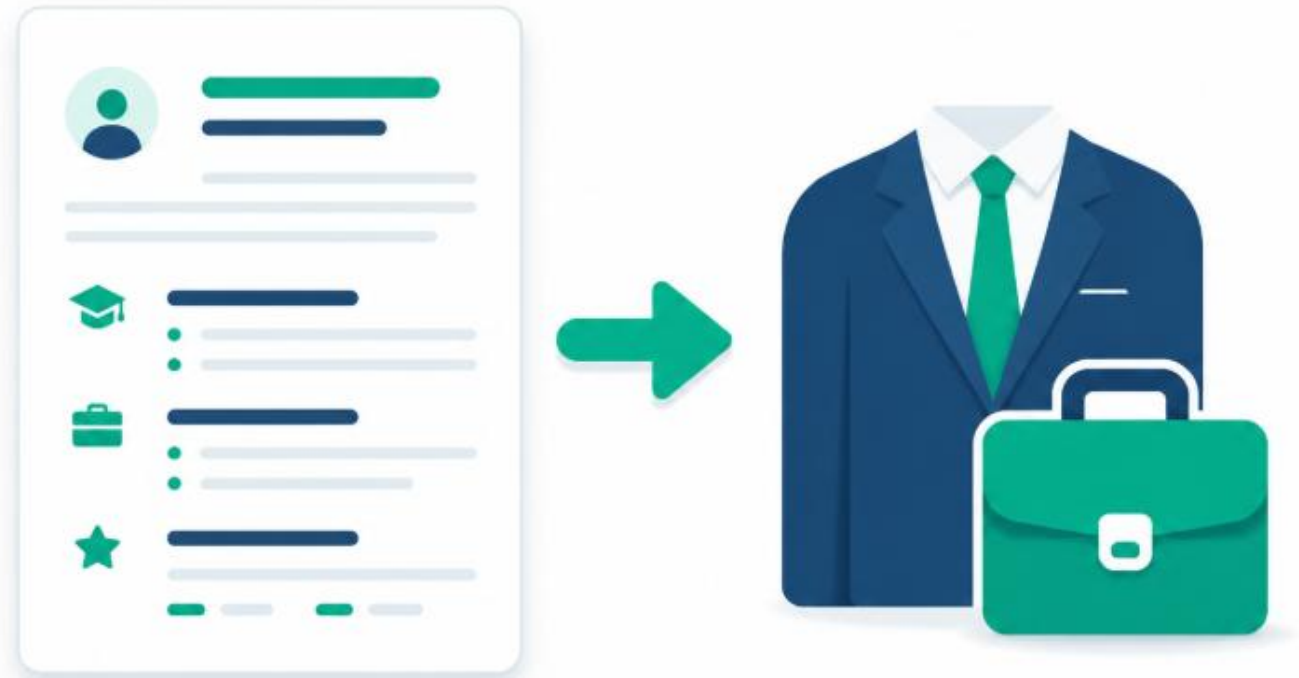


# CV Writing and Interviewing Skills



# Session Learning Objectives

**By the end of this session, participants will learn how to:**

- 1 Recall the hiring process and describe how an ATS screens a CV.
- 2 Explain the purpose of every CV section and what a recruiter looks for in it.
- 3 Apply CV writing rules using action verbs, evidence, and measurable results.
- 4 Analyse weak and strong CV samples to identify the errors that cost an interview.
- 5 Evaluate AI-generated CV content and interview answers against the job advert.
- 6 Create a tailored CV and a set of STAR-structured interview answers.

# Key Topics Covered

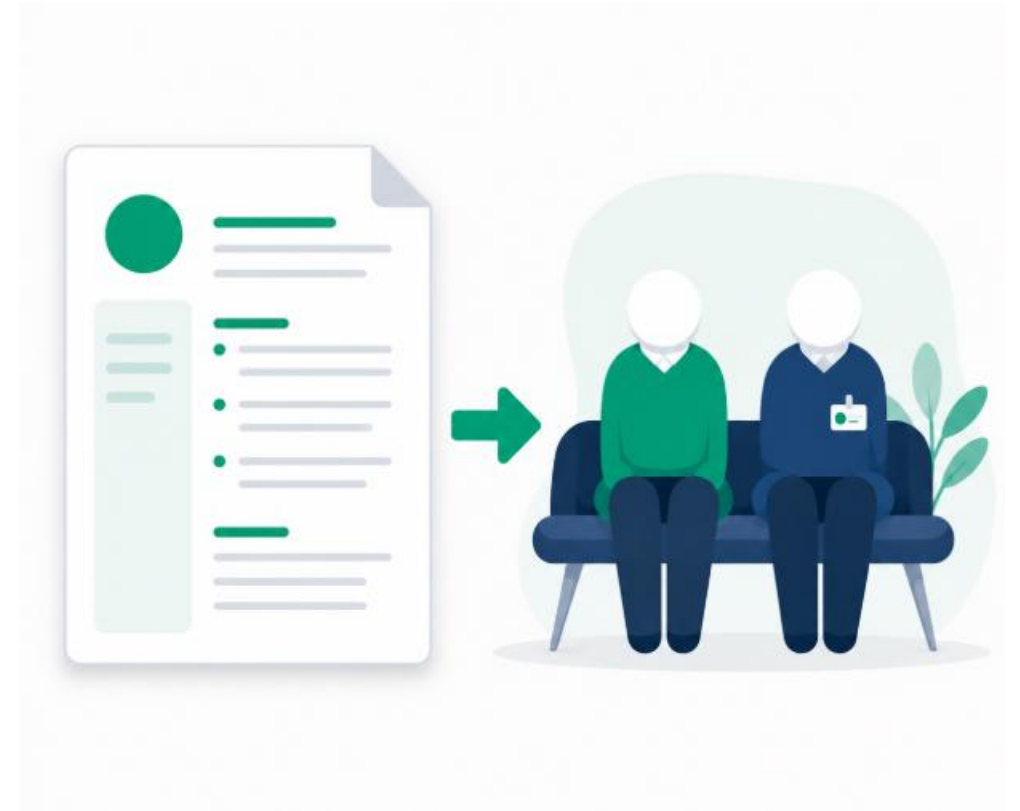
- Why we write a CV
- The hiring process
- Applicant Tracking Systems
- The CV sections, one by one
- Real samples: weak and strong
- **AI Activity: tailor your CV**
- Layout and formatting rules
- The final CV checklist
- Competency-based interviews
- Preparing: ten tips
- Sample interview questions
- The STAR method
- **AI Activity: rehearse the interview**
- Recap and assignment

# Why Do We Write a CV?

## To get an INTERVIEW

Not to get the job. Only the meeting.

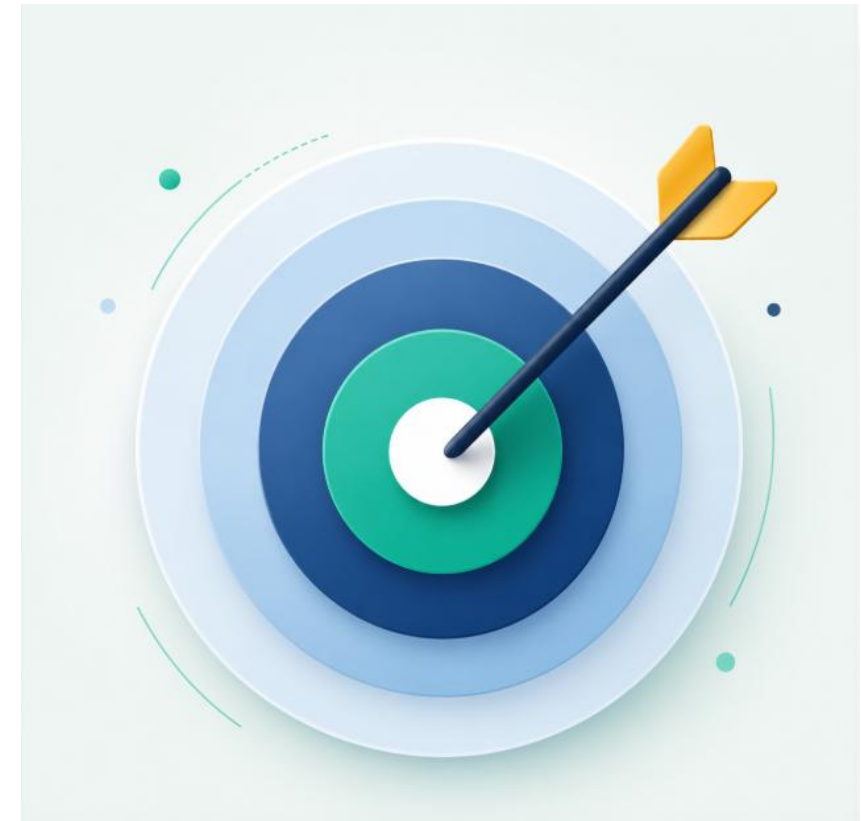
- Add what is relevant to this job
- Cut what belongs to another one
- Prove it, never just claim it



# What That Means in Practice

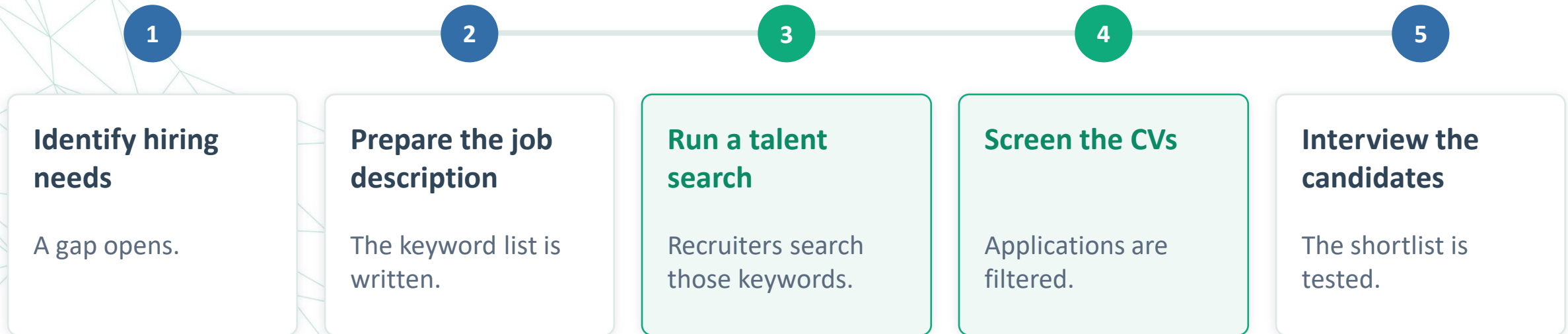
Three habits that separate a shortlisted CV from an ignored one.

- 1 Relevance over completeness**  
Your CV is not an archive. Every line supports this one application.
- 2 Evidence over adjectives**  
Hard worker proves nothing. A result with a number proves everything.
- 3 Scanned before it is read**  
The first pass takes seconds. If the match is not visible, the CV is set aside.



# The Hiring Process

Five steps. Your CV decides two of them.



# Where Your CV Enters the Process

Two gates, two different tests.

## Talent search

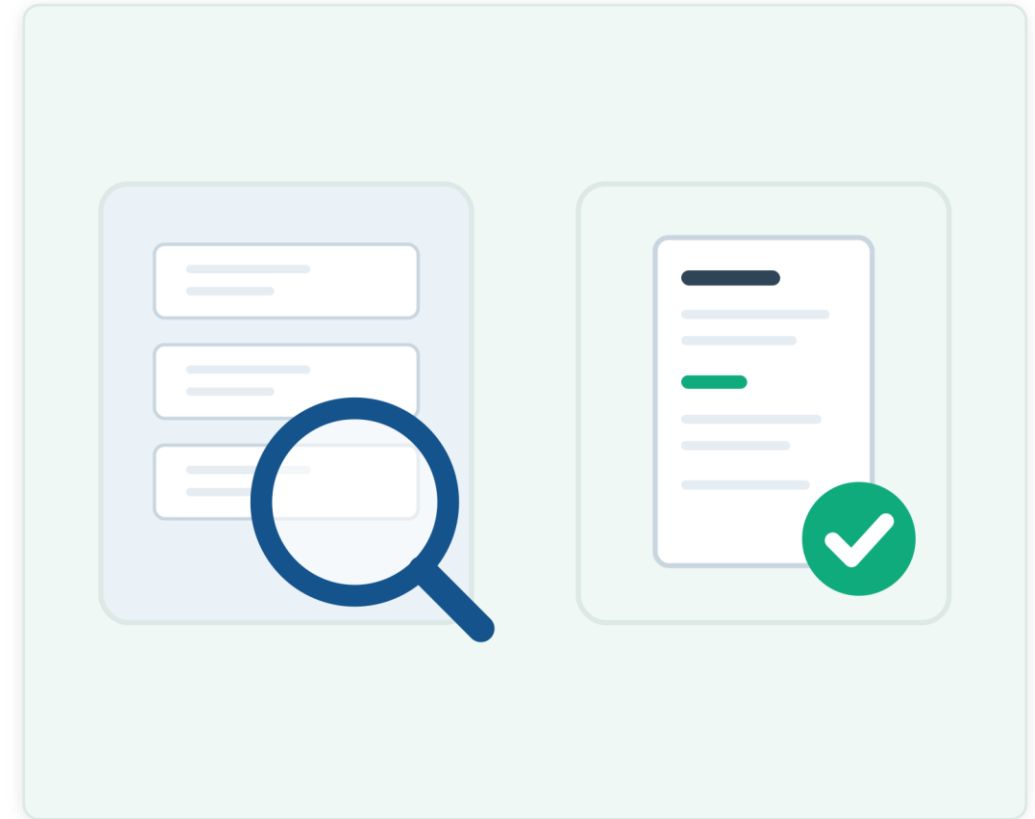
### FINDABILITY

If the advert's words are missing from your CV, you never appear in the results.

## CV screening

### RELEVANCE

Missing evidence reads as a missing skill. Irrelevant lines push relevant ones down.





# What is an ATS?

## Applicant Tracking System

Software used by recruiters to track candidates through the hiring process. It automatically scans and sorts applications by keywords, skills, and experience.

**It is not a judge of quality. It is a filter that reads structure and vocabulary.**





# How an ATS Reads Your CV

1

## Parse

It breaks your file into fields. A layout it cannot read becomes an empty field.

2

## Match

It compares those fields against the words the employer used in the advert.

3

## Rank

It orders applications so the recruiter opens the strongest matches first.

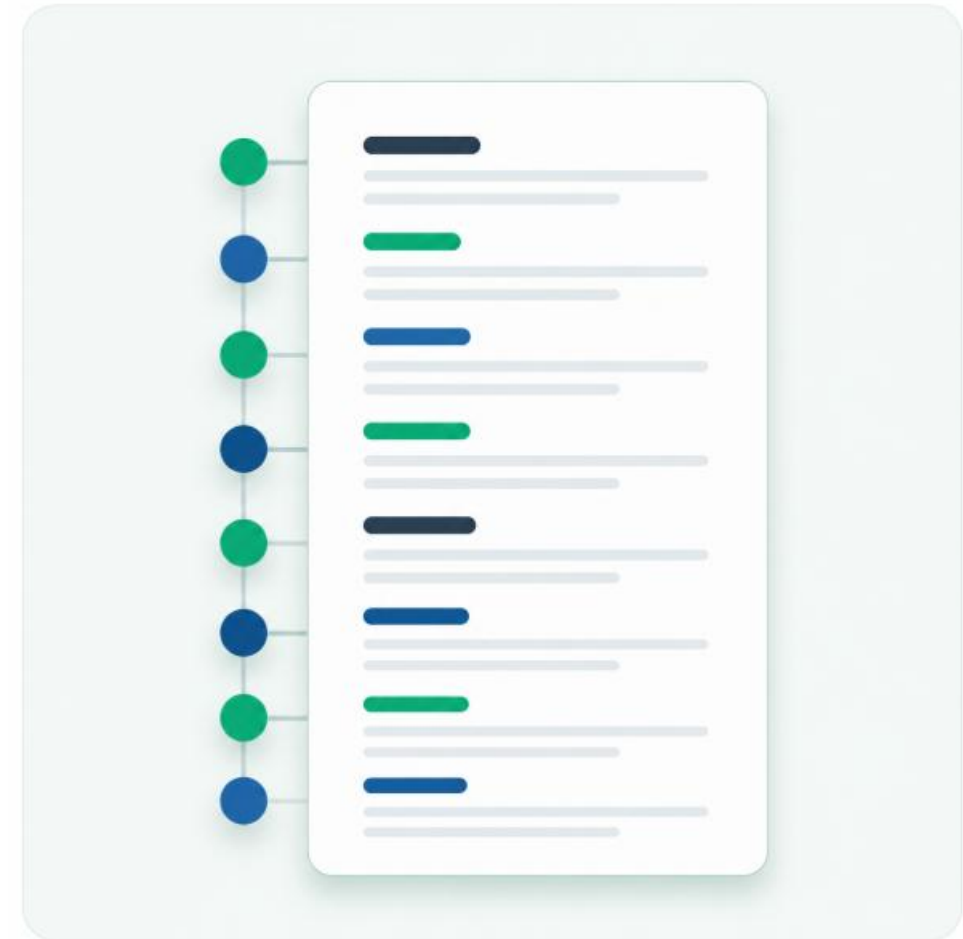


## Staying ATS-Friendly

- Use the advert's own job title
- Write technology names in full
- Keep standard section headings
- One column. No tables or text boxes
- Never put evidence inside an image



# What Are the CV Sections?



# Contact Information: Common Mistakes

Three real samples. Look before you read the verdict.



## Contact Me

+20-1[redacted] 034  
[redacted]010@gmail.com  
shobra  
Cairo, EGYPT

## Ahmed Fahim El-bahy

Chemist

[redacted]@gmail.com • +[redacted]178481 • Cairo, Egypt • 10/12/1999 • complete

## Ahmed Mohsen Hanafy

Software Engineer

Tel. No.: [redacted]20 Email:  
[redacted]sen9623@gmail.com  
GitHub: github.com/[redacted]

Nationality : Egyptian

Date of Birth : 6<sup>th</sup> Nov 1998

Military status : Completed

Address : Cairo, Egypt

## WHY THESE FAIL

- Personal data no employer may ask for: date of birth, nationality, marital and military status.
- Contact details drawn as icons only. A parser reads no label and leaves the field empty.
- An informal email address, and a district instead of city and country.

# Contact Information: Strong Example

Everything a recruiter needs, in plain text, in four lines.

## Ammar Mohamed Azooz

0100xxxxxxxx | Dokki, Giza, Egypt

a.m.azooz@email.com

linkedin.com/in/ammazarazooz/

## WHY THIS WORKS

- Full name at the top, larger than anything else on the page.
- Phone, city and country, email and LinkedIn, all as readable text.
- No date of birth, no nationality, no marital status, no photograph.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ammar Mohamed Azooz</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| 0100xxxxxxxx   Dokki, Giza, Egypt<br>a.m.azooz@email.com<br>linkedin.com/in/ammazarazooz/                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Education</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Faculty of Commerce, English Section, Cairo University (June 2019)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Major: Business                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Grade:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Work Experience</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Senior Recruitment Specialist, LAMAR Egypt (Feb. 2019 - Present)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Perform the full life cycle of recruitment for white-collar employees.</li> <li>• Perform full recruitment process for massive blue-collar employees for Lamar DC's and Nubaria Plant</li> <li>• Ensure job profiles and position requirements are aligned with business objectives.</li> </ul>               |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Internships</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Teacher, The Nest Nursery and Preschool Institution (Aug. 2017-Sep. 2017)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Teach preschoolers English, Arabic, and Art basics.</li> <li>• Prepare lesson plans and schedules.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Extracurricular Activities</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| President and Project Manager, VIA Club, Cairo University (2017- 2018)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Managed a team of 100 members.</li> <li>• Created a program of 4 phases with 7 strong multinational companies (IBM, Cisco, Vodafone, UNODC, Deloitte, P&amp;G, and Allianz).</li> <li>• Funded our project with funds worth 50,000 EGP.</li> <li>• Reached 55+k through our social media platform.</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Courses</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Digital Marketing Course, Udemy, 75 Hours (Nov.2021)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Skills</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Computer Skills:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>Language Skills:</b>                                                                                                       | <b>Computer Language Skills:</b>                                          |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• MS Package</li> <li>• AutoCad</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Arabic: Native</li> <li>• English: Very Good</li> <li>• French: Very Good</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• C++</li> <li>• Python</li> </ul> |
| <b>Projects</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Tappeti (March.2022)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| Tappeti is an efficient admin dashboard website for managing carpet sales and factory resources. Built with Angular and Angular Material, it streamlines operations and enhances resource management.                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <b>Familiar With:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                               |                                                                           |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Photoshop</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Javascript</li> </ul>                                                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Illustrator</li> </ul>           |

# Career Objective: Common Mistakes

Two samples. Both well written, both useless to a recruiter.

## Objective

My Motivating factor is to be an added value to the place I join and to see that I am positively contributing to the post I hold and to the organization I serve loyally. I work very hard with calibers, pushing them to acquire more skills and build knowledge to achieve our goals.

## Professional Goals

I am looking to be a member of the team work in a reputable & successful company or organization where my knowledge and ability could be fully utilized .Which enables me to be professional while meeting the Company goal and to have a chance to develop my skills that will get more experience to meet my ambition.

---

## WHY THESE FAIL

- They describe what the candidate wants, not what the employer gets.
- No role is named, so the same paragraph fits any application.
- No skill or tool appears, so there is nothing to match or search.
- Too long. A screener reading in seconds skips a dense block entirely.



# Career Objective: Strong Examples

Same length as the weak versions. Far more information.

## Objective

**Highly skilled .NET Developer with experience in designing, developing, and maintaining web applications using the .NET framework. Proficient in C#, ASP.NET, MVC, and SQL Server with a strong background in full-stack development. Proven ability to deliver high-quality software solutions on time and within budget. Excellent problem-solving skills and a passion for continuous learning and professional development.**

## PROFILE

I am a Software Engineer with experience in building efficient web and mobile applications with a focus on good performance and user experience. I have strong skills in ASP.NET Core, Django, and Flutter. Skilled in both backend and frontend development, I provide complete solutions for complex projects. I focus on creating robust solutions and driving project success through well-crafted technology and strategic implementation.

## WHY THESE WORK

- The role is named in the first three three words.
- Concrete technologies appear, which is what a search looks for.
- The level is stated, so the reader can place the candidate.
- They close on the value to the employer, not the candidate's ambition.

**Role + Level + Core tools + Value**



# Education: The Five Elements

- **Degree**  
Written in full: B.Sc., B.A., Bachelor of Commerce.
- **Major**  
The specialisation the employer is screening for.
- **Institution**  
Full official name, correctly capitalised.
- **Date**  
Graduation month and year, or the study period.
- **Grade**  
State it when it is competitive or requested.



# Education: Common Mistakes

Read these as if you had four more CVs waiting.

## EDUCATION

2018-2021

**FACULTY OF COMMERCE**

alexandria university

## Education

- Bachelor of Engineering Ain Shams University, Egypt.

## WHY THESE FAIL

- The degree is missing. A faculty name is not a qualification.
- The institution is written in lowercase on a document about your standards.
- No graduation date, no major, and no grade to compare against the requirement.

# Education: Strong Examples

## Education:

**2019-2023:** B.Sc. of Computer Science from Modern University for Technology & Information (MTI)

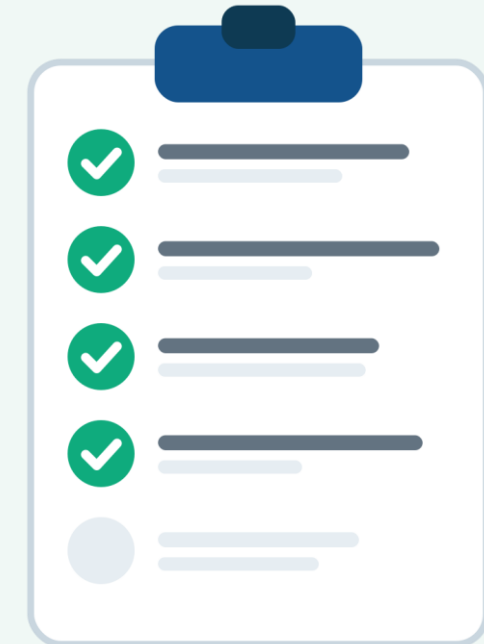
## Education

**Bachelor of Commerce**, University of Mansoura, June 2019

- Major: Accounting
- General Grade: Good

## THE RULE

- Reverse chronological order: your most recent qualification comes first, always.



# Experience: The Bullet Formula

The section that carries more weight than any other.

Action verb + what you did + which tool + what changed

## Weak

*Responsible for the procurement of materials.*

## Strong

*Procured materials for three national projects, keeping delivery on schedule.*



# Experience: Common Mistakes

Four real samples.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

- experience (1.5 year oct 2020-2022)
  - Diploma full stack developer .net
- experience (3 month dec 2022-march 2023)
  - Training front end (with react js)
  - (creativa) information technology institute
- El-Araby Group | Sep 2020- Nov 2020
  - Introduction to C programming by practicing problem solving.

## Internships

- Embedded systems**
  - summer internship program as intern at the artificial intelligence technology center (AITC) February 2023
- UI/UX Designer**
  - virtual internship program as a UI/UX Designer by intern2grow 22-27october 2023

- Problem Solving**  
**Coach Academy**  
07/2021 – 09/2021
- Introduction to Programming in C++
  - Covered fundamentals of computer science and programming using C++.

- Competitive Programming**  
**Coach Academy**  
07/2022 – 09/2022
- Learned various sorting algorithms
  - Acquired skills in searching algorithms including Binary Search.
  - Gained proficiency in implementing these algorithms efficiently for competitive programming challenges.

- Internships**
- Codsoft company .
  - TechHacks company .
  - Pioneers of Digital Egypt Initiative.

## WHY THESE FAIL

- A spelling error in the section heading itself.
- Employer, role, and dates mixed together instead of on predictable lines.
- Bullets list what the role involved, never what the candidate achieved.
- No numbers anywhere, so every claim stays unverifiable.

## Experience: Strong Example (Work)

The anatomy of an entry a screener reads in one pass.

**Senior Procurement Engineer**

**May, 2022 – Oct, 2022**

**The Arab Contractors, Helwan Branch**

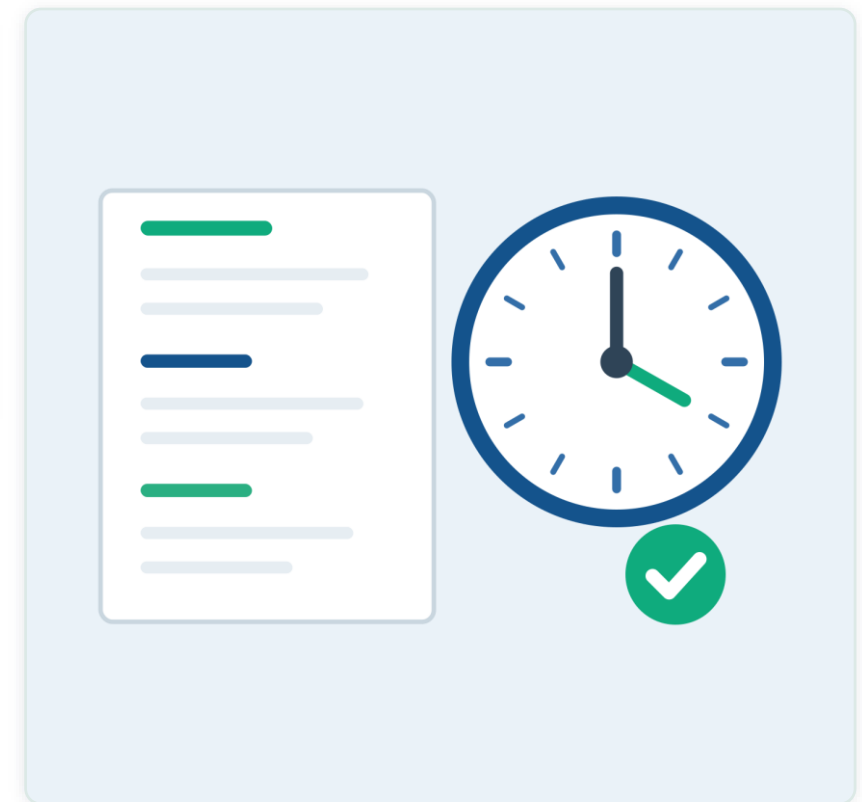
- Procure equipment, materials and systems that comply with project requirements
- Ensure timely delivery of equipment and materials to support site installation
- Maintain positive relationships with suppliers and subcontractors, ensuring company reputation and credibility.
- **Key Projects** : Cairo Monorail Project & The Islamic Cultural Center(Administrative Capital) & Egyptian Military Academy(Administrative Capital)

**Line 1** Job title left, dates right. Same on every entry.

**Line 2** Employer and location. Nothing else on this line.

**Bullets** Three to five, each opening with a past-tense verb.

**Evidence** Named projects and a scale the reader can picture.



# Experience: Strong Example (Internship)

An internship is written with exactly the same discipline as a paid role.

## **BIM Structure Intern KAITECH, Egypt**

( August 2021 – November 2021)

- Utilize BIM software such as Revit and Navisworks Dynamo BIM360 to develop and coordinate building design models in 3D.
- Collaborate with architects and engineers to integrate MEP systems into the building design.
- Conduct clash detection and resolution to identify and resolve design conflicts
- Create and manage construction documents including 2D drawings, schedules, and Specifications.

## **WHY THIS WORKS**

- Role, organisation, and a clear date range.
- The tools are named, which is what a technical screen searches for.
- The scope is honest for an internship and does not pretend to be senior.





# Courses and Certificates: Common Mistakes

A section that is usually written in a hurry.

## Courses

|      |                                  |
|------|----------------------------------|
| 2024 | <b>Power Distribution course</b> |
| 2023 | <b>Embedded Systems Diploma</b>  |

## Certificates

- (28 April 2023) Approaches to software development , Open University
- (3 March-13March2023) UI/UX design , Edrak.com
- (November 2022)Data analysis challenger track, Udacity
- (2 August 2021 -26 August 2021) UI/UX design , ITI

## WHY THESE FAIL

- A course title with a year and no provider.
- Date formats that change from line to line.
- No length or depth, so a webinar looks like a diploma.
- Courses with no connection to the role being applied for.

# Courses and Certificates: Strong Example

Four elements per entry, and every entry earns its place.

## Problem Solving Coach Academy

07/2021 – 09/2021

- Introduction to Programming in C++
- Covered fundamentals of computer science and programming using C++.

## Competitive Programming Coach Academy

07/2022 – 09/2022

- Learned various sorting algorithms
- Acquired skills in searching algorithms including Binary Search.
- Gained proficiency in implementing these algorithms efficiently for competitive programming challenges.

## WHY THIS WORKS

- Title, provider, and date range, formatted the same way every time.
- A short line under each entry stating what was covered, which adds keywords.
- Entries relevant to the target role, so the section supports the application.

## KEEP

- Recognised professional certifications
- Diplomas and tracks with real duration
- Anything the advert names directly

## CUT

- One-hour webinars and attendance slips
- Courses unrelated to the role
- Anything you could not be questioned on

# Skills: How to Write the Section

1

## Group them

Technical skills, tools and platforms, languages. Three labelled blocks.

2

## Name the technology

Write React, not modern frameworks. That is what a search matches.

3

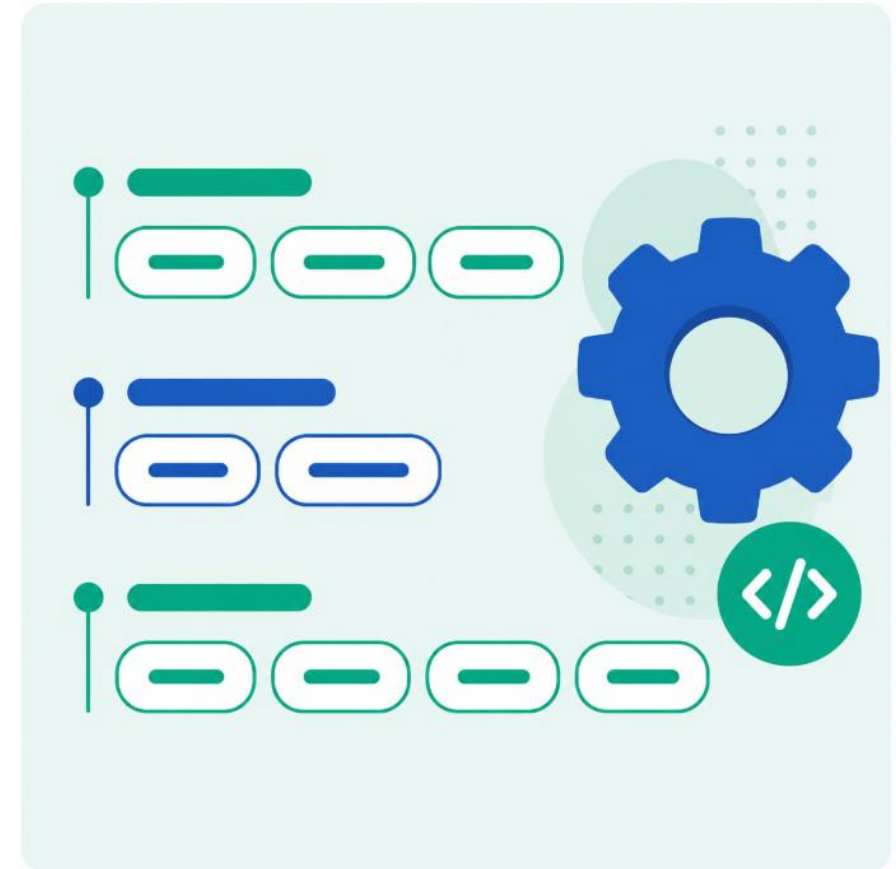
## State an honest level

Proficient, familiar with, basic understanding. Three different claims.

4

## Move soft skills out

Prove them in your Experience bullets, do not list them here.



# Skills: Common Mistakes

Ask yourself what either sample tells a hiring manager.

## SOFT SKILLS

---

- Self-motivated.
- Attention to details.
- Critical thinking.
- Communication.
- Team player.
- Curiosity.

## SKILLS

---

- Excellent Command of PC skills. (Windows-Web browsing- Word- Excel)
- Problem Solving
- Basic knowledge in HTML and CSS.
- Excellent Written and Non-Written Communication.

## WHY THESE FAIL

- Personality adjectives with no evidence anywhere in the CV to support them.
- Vague phrases such as excellent command of PC skills, which cannot be tested.
- Basic knowledge sitting beside real working skills, with no levels shown.
- No grouping, so the reader has to sort the list themselves.

# Skills: Strong Examples

Grouped under headings, named exactly as the industry writes them.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

- C# , c++
- JavaScript / ES6
- ASP .NET Core MVC
- React js
- RESTful API
- HTML5 / CSS3
- Entity Framework Core
- Bootstrap
- LINQ

### Frontend development

- Html/CSS , JavaScript ,Bootstrap , UI/UX design ,Responsive Design

### Backend development

- C# , LINQ , Microsoft SQL server , ASP Web API ,MVC .net core

### Other

- Java programing language, Software engineering concepts, SOLD Principles

- Proficient in HTML, CSS, Sass Integration, and JavaScript.
- Familiar with modern front-end libraries and frameworks like React and BootStrap.
- Basic understanding of responsive web design.

## Language Skills

Arabic: Native

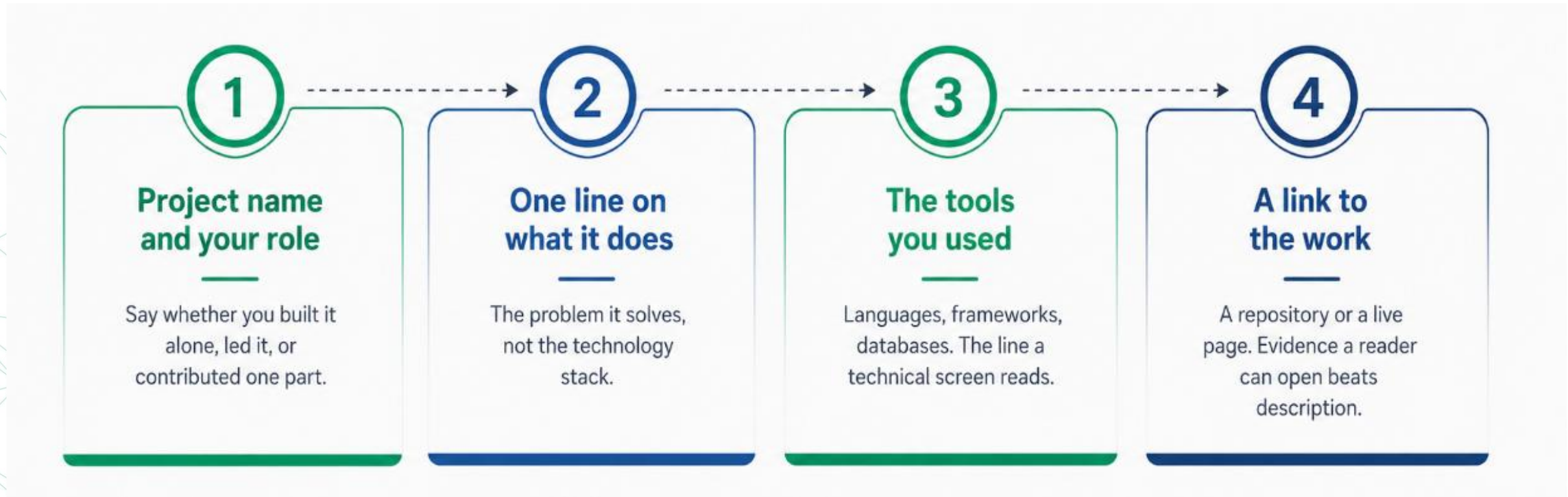
English: Very Good

French: Very Good

## WHY THESE WORK

- Grouped under headings, so the reader finds what they need.
- Frontend and backend separated, so the candidate can be placed immediately.
- Honest levels: proficient, familiar with, basic understanding.
- Languages in their own labelled block, not buried in a general list.

# Projects: When and What to Include





# Projects: Strong Examples

- **kAPPot IOS Mobile Application (Graduation Project)**

**Project Description:** An application that helps users in emergency cases to order a specific car spare part or to get the nearest service centers to repair their car based on user location.

**Tools** swift 5, Firebase, Google Maps, Google places, Cocoapods.

**GitHub Link:** <https://github.com/xDeuxer/kAPPot>

- **Bikeshare System**

**Project Description:** The datasets selected for three major cities in the United States – Chicago, New York City, and Washington. The system allows users to rent bicycles on a very short-term basis for a price. And our project is to produce insights based on our dataset and answer interesting questions about it by computing descriptive statistics

**Tools:** Python.

## Projects

### E-commerce Platform Development

- Developed a comprehensive e-commerce platform using ASP.NET Core and Angular, featuring product listings, user authentication, shopping cart functionality, and payment integration.\*

### Inventory Management System

- Designed and implemented an inventory management system for a mid-sized company, utilizing ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, and SQL Server to manage stock levels, orders, and suppliers.\*

## WHY THESE WORK

- Name first, then the problem in plain language, then the tools.
- The first sample gives a repository link, which turns a claim into something verifiable.
- The second names the features built, so the scope of the work is clear.



# Extracurricular Activities

An optional section. Include it only when it proves something the rest of the CV cannot.

**"What changed because you were there?"**

## If the answer is nothing

- That is attendance. It belongs in a conversation, not on a CV.

## If the answer is something

- Write the role you held, the scale, and the result you reached.



# Extracurricular Activities: Common Mistake

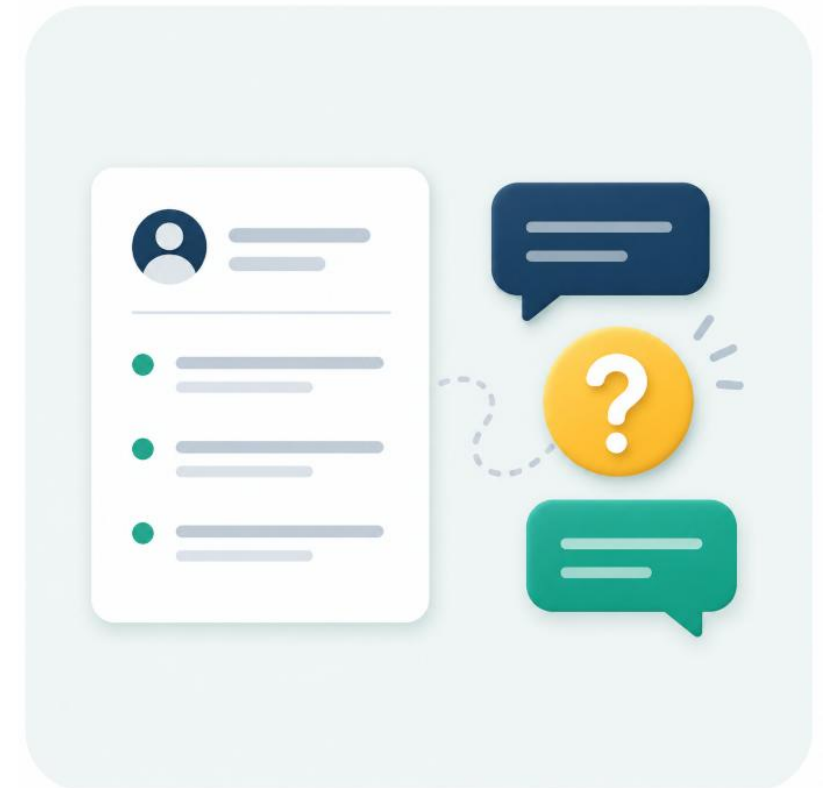
One real sample, written as a list of places.

## Activity:

- EGYPT INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION CENTER. (2019)
- EGYPT INTERNATIONAL EXHIBITION CENTER. (2020)
- Egypt International Summit for Digital Transformation and Cybersecurity (EISDTC). (2024)
- Volantiring at (سفرءاء- خير- أمة) (oct 2023)

## WHY THIS FAILS

- Event names with no role attached, so nobody can tell what the candidate did.
- No contribution and no outcome, which leaves attendance as the only claim.
- Inconsistent language and formatting, including two languages in one entry.



# Extracurricular Activities: Strong Example

Same section, written as a role with a scope and a result.

## President and Project Manager, VIA Club, Cairo University (2017 - 2018)

- Managing a team of 100 members.
- Creating a program of 4 phases with 7 strong multinational companies (IBM, Cisco, Vodafone, UNODC, Deloitte, P&G, and Allianz).
- Funding our project with funds worth of 50,000 EGP.
- Reaching 55+k through our social media platform.

## ONE MORE IMPROVEMENT

Switch the -ing verbs to past tense:

*Managed a team of 100 members.*

*Built a four-phase program with seven partners.*

*Secured 50,000 EGP in funding.*

*Reached over 55,000 people.*

Past tense states the work is finished and the result is yours.

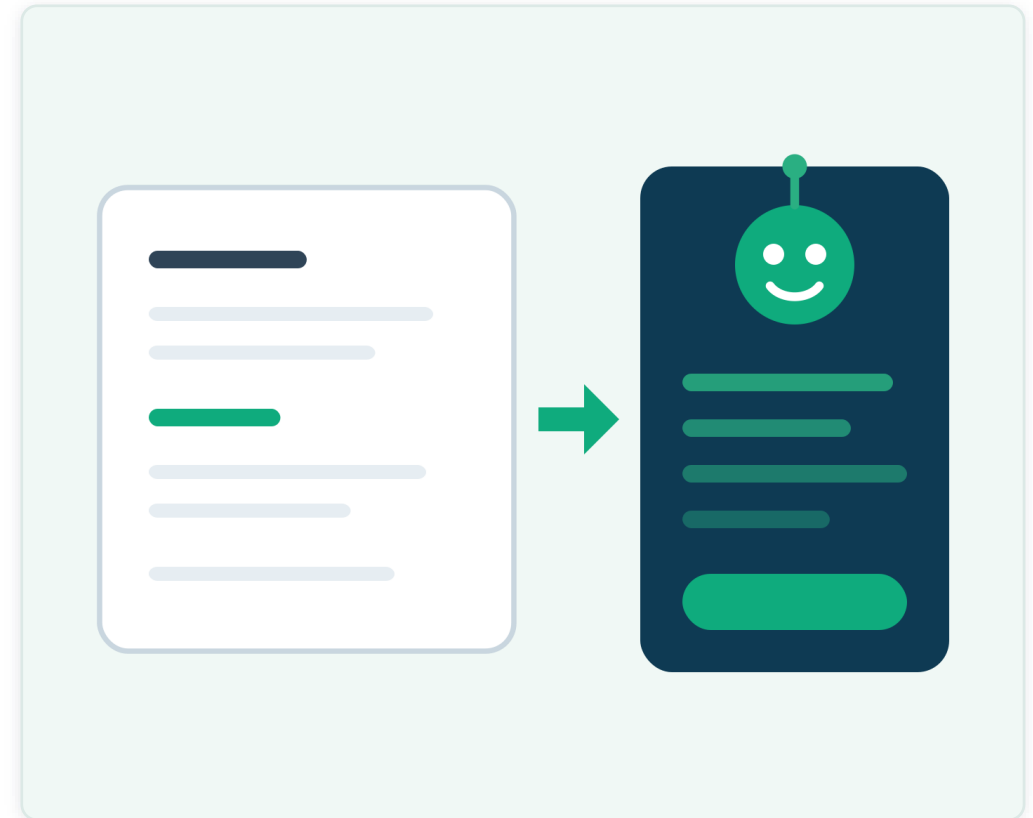
# Where AI Helps, and Where It Must Not

## AI CAN

- Find the keywords you are missing
- Restructure and shorten your bullets
- Critique and score a draft

## AI MUST NOT

- Supply an experience you did not have
- Invent a number, a percentage, or a result
- Write a claim you could not defend in an interview



## Activity - Tailor Your CV with an AI ATS Reviewer

1

### Feed it the advert and your CV

Paste the full job advert, then your current CV text. Name the exact role you are targeting.

2

### Extract the keyword map

Ask for the must-have and nice-to-have terms, and which ones your CV already proves.

3

### Rewrite your weakest bullets

Ask for each as: action verb, task, tool, result. Then check every number yourself.

4

### Score, cut, and humanise

Ask for a match score and the gaps, then delete any claim you could not defend.

### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

*"Act as an ATS screening tool and a technical recruiter.*

*Job advert: [paste the advert]. My CV: [paste your CV].*

*1) List the must-have and nice-to-have keywords in the advert.*

*2) Mark which ones my CV proves, and which are missing.*

*3) Rewrite my 5 weakest bullets as: action verb + task + tool + measurable result.*

*4) Give a match score out of 100 and the 3 highest-impact changes."*

**Output: a tailored, ATS-ready CV for one real job**

# Layout Rules: The Page

1

## Length

One to two pages. One page for a fresh graduate.

2

## Font

A clean, readable font. 10 to 12 pt body, 14 to 16 pt for your name.

3

## Margins and spacing

Comfortable margins and white space between sections.



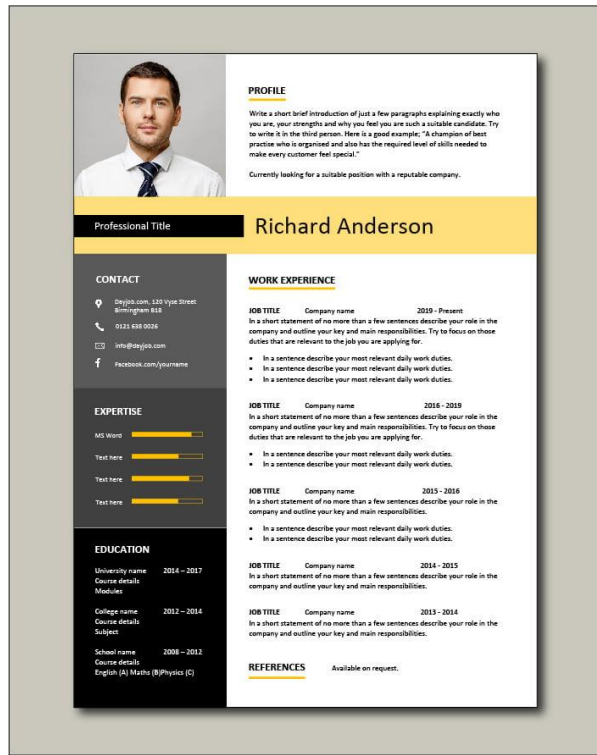
# Layout Rules: The Structure





# A Full CV: What Not to Do

Impressive to a human eye, close to zero in an automated screen.



## Two columns

The parser reads across the page and merges both columns into one line.

## Graphics and icons

They carry no text, so everything they represent is invisible.

## Rating bars

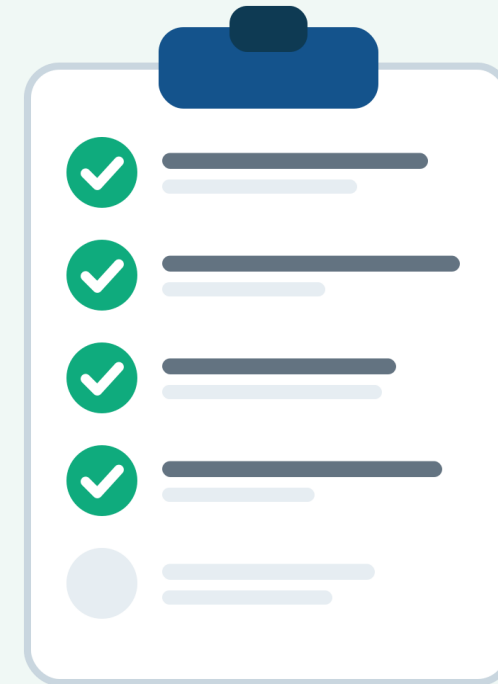
A four-out-of-five bar means nothing. Nobody knows the scale.

## A photograph

No evidence, less space for content, and exposure to bias.

# The Final CV Checklist

- ☐ No photo unless the employer asks for one
- ☐ Bullet points, never paragraphs
- ☐ Reverse chronological order, newest first
- ☐ Never copy and paste from anyone else
- ☐ Avoid templates built on tables and columns
- ☐ Send as PDF unless Word is requested





**15 MINUTES**

# Interviewing Skills

---



# What is a Competency-Based Interview?

## A prepared list of questions

1

Asked of every candidate, so the process stays comparable and fair.

## Each question tests one skill

2

Teamwork, problem solving, pressure. Nothing is asked by asked by accident.

## Answers are scored against criteria

3

The score decides the outcome, not the impression you left.



## What this changes for you

A charming answer with no example scores lower than a plain answer with a real one. Prepare examples, not personality.

# How Would You Prepare for a Job Interview?

Put your answer in the chat before the next slide.

**You have an interview in three days for a role you want.**

**What do you do between now and then?**

Research

Examples

Practice

Questions to ask

Logistics

# Preparing for the Interview: Tips 1 to 5

1

## Read the job advert

It is the syllabus for the interview.

2

## Pick out the competencies

One example ready for each skill listed.

3

## Research the company

What they do, what changed, who is interviewing you.

4

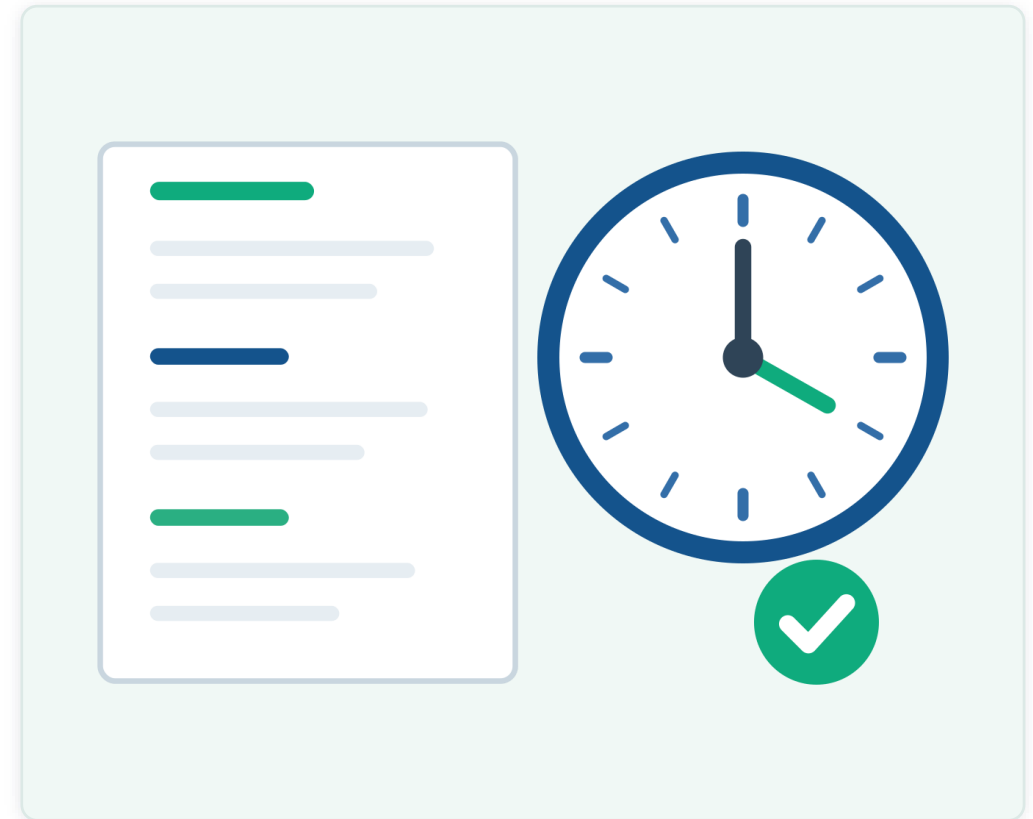
## Prepare your introduction

Ninety seconds. Say it out loud.

5

## Practise with a person

Not in your head. A listener interrupts.





## Preparing for the Interview: Tips 6 to 10

1

### **Prepare your evidence**

A real situation, action, and result per skill.

2

### **Prepare questions to ask**

Two or three about the role or the team.

3

### **Come with an open mind**

The role may not match what you expected.

4

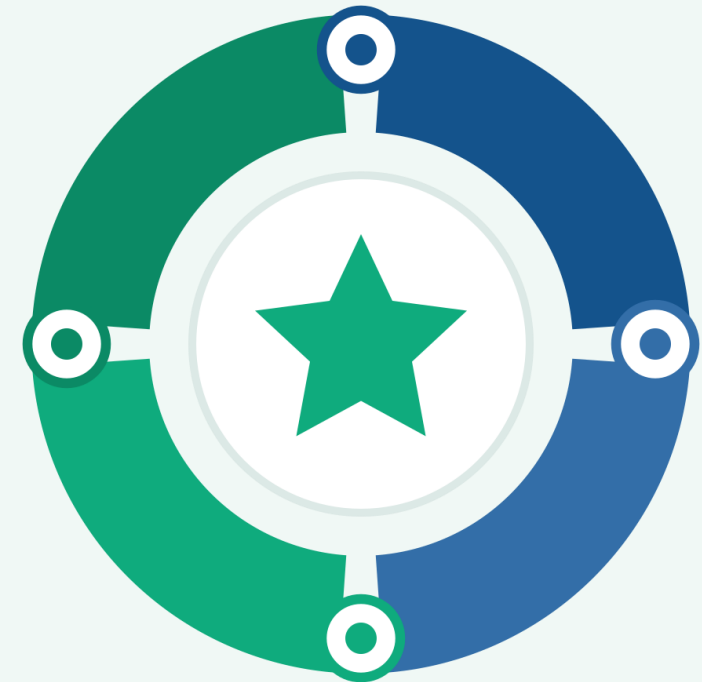
### **Mind body language and tone**

Eye contact, open posture, a pace people follow.

5

### **Visualise success**

It reduces the nerves that rush your answers.



# Sample Questions: Motivation and Background

- 1 Introduce yourself.
- 2 Why do you want to work as a ..... (job profile)?
- 3 Why do you want to work for XYZ?
- 4 What has been your biggest achievement so far?
- 5 What are your career goals?

## WHAT IS BEING TESTED

Can you be concise?

Do you understand the role?

Did you prepare at all?

Can you structure evidence?

Will you still be here in two years?

# Sample Questions: Competency-Based

- 1 Give an example of a team project that you achieved successfully.
- 2 Give me an example of a challenge you faced and how you overcame it.
- 3 Give an example of how you handled a difficult client successfully.
- 4 Give an example of a situation where you solved a problem creatively.
- 5 What would you do if ...

## THE COMPETENCY BEHIND IT

Teamwork

Resilience and problem solving

Client handling and communication

Creative thinking

Judgement under a hypothetical

# How to Answer: The STAR Method

## **S** SITUATION

Set the context in one or two sentences.

## **T** TASK

State the problem or responsibility that was yours.

## **A** ACTION

What you did, in the first person. The longest part.

## **R** RESULT

The outcome, with a number wherever you have one.

**Keep Situation and Task short. Action and Result are what the interviewer is marking.**

## Activity - Rehearse with an AI Interviewer

1

### Set the scene

Give the AI the job advert and your CV, and ask it to act as the hiring manager for that role.

2

### Run a five-question mock

One question at a time. Say your answer out loud first, then type it.

3

### Get scored against STAR

Ask it to mark each answer on Situation, Task, Action and Result, and name what is missing.

4

### Rebuild your two weakest

Rewrite them with real numbers from your own history, then run the mock again.

### READY-TO-USE PROMPT

*"Act as the hiring manager interviewing me for this role: [paste the the advert]."*

*This is my CV: [paste your CV].*

*Ask me 5 competency-based questions, one at a time, and wait for my answer before the next.*

*After each answer, score it out of 5 on Situation, Task, Action and Result, and say exactly what evidence is missing.*

*At the end, name the 2 answers I should rebuild first."*

**Output: 5 STAR-scored answers and a and a rehearsal plan**

# Recap

## Now we know how to:

- Write for the two steps where a CV is searched and screened
- Format a document that both a system and a person can read
- Build every section on evidence, not adjectives
- Tell a weak sample from a strong one, and judge your own the same way
- Answer a competency question with STAR, in the first person
- Use AI to tailor and rehearse, and verify every claim it produces



# Thank You!

Thank you for your participation and attention.

